



An Roinn Dlí agus Cirt
Department of Justice

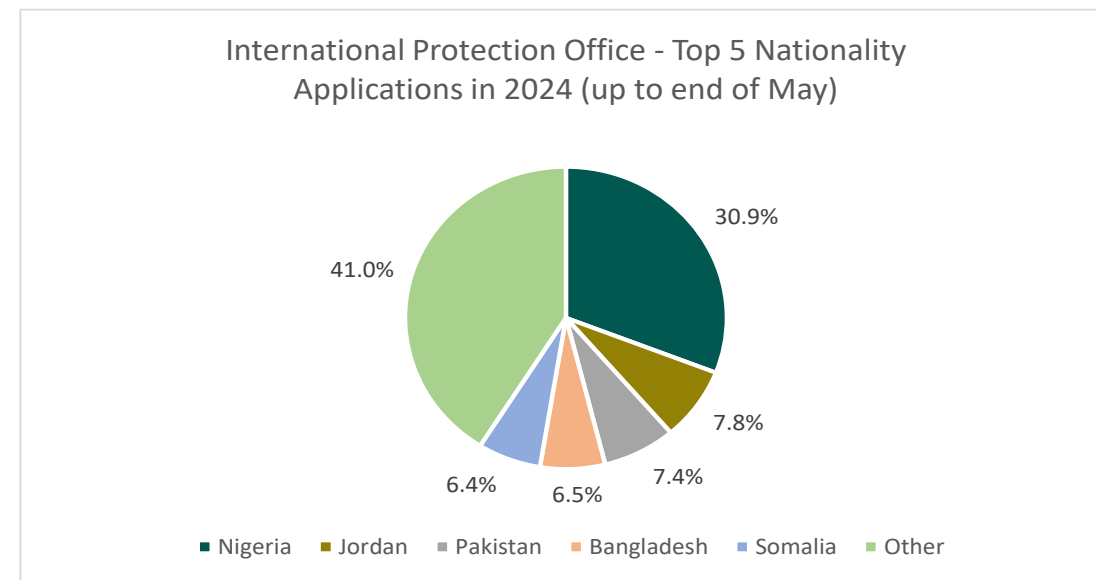
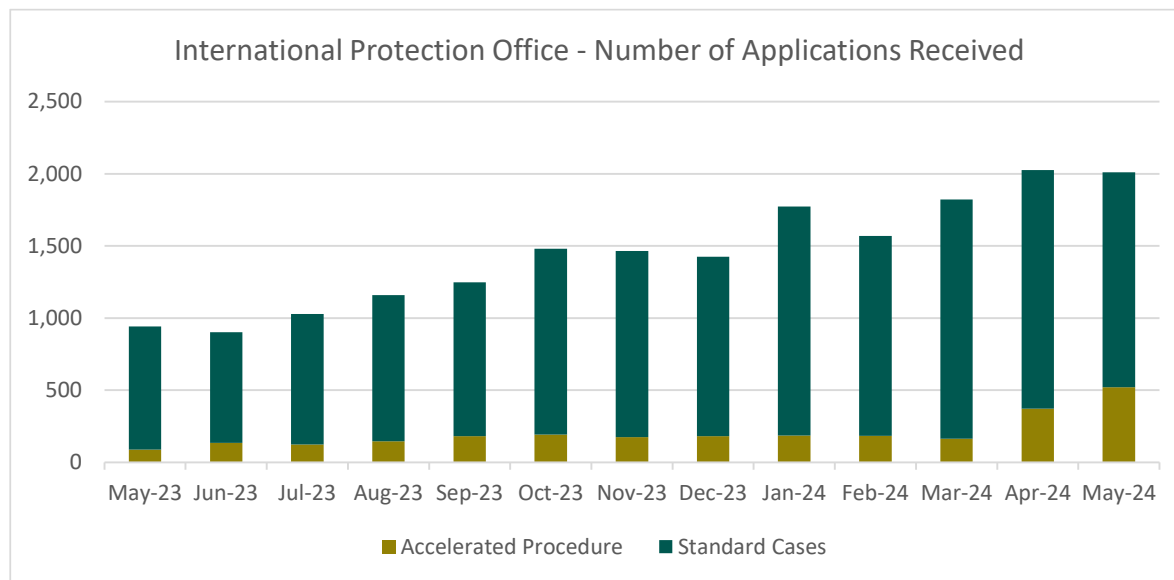
International Protection: May 2024

Executive Summary

The figures in this dashboard were extracted on the 12th June 2024. These are operational figures and subject to change. The charts below refer to key points in the asylum process. A flow chart is provided at the end of the pack that sets out this process. Overall, for May 2024:

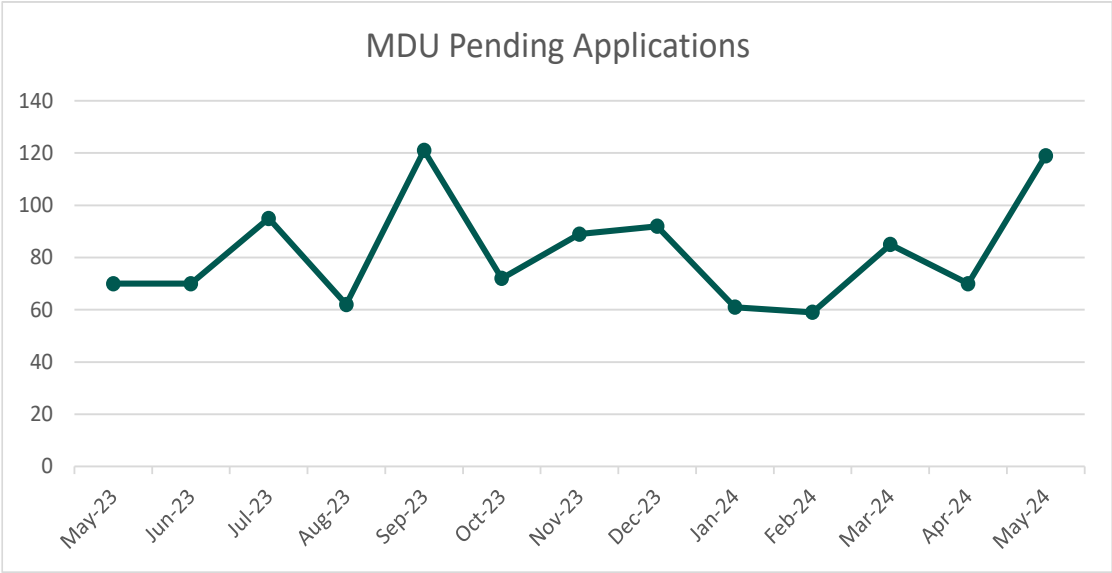
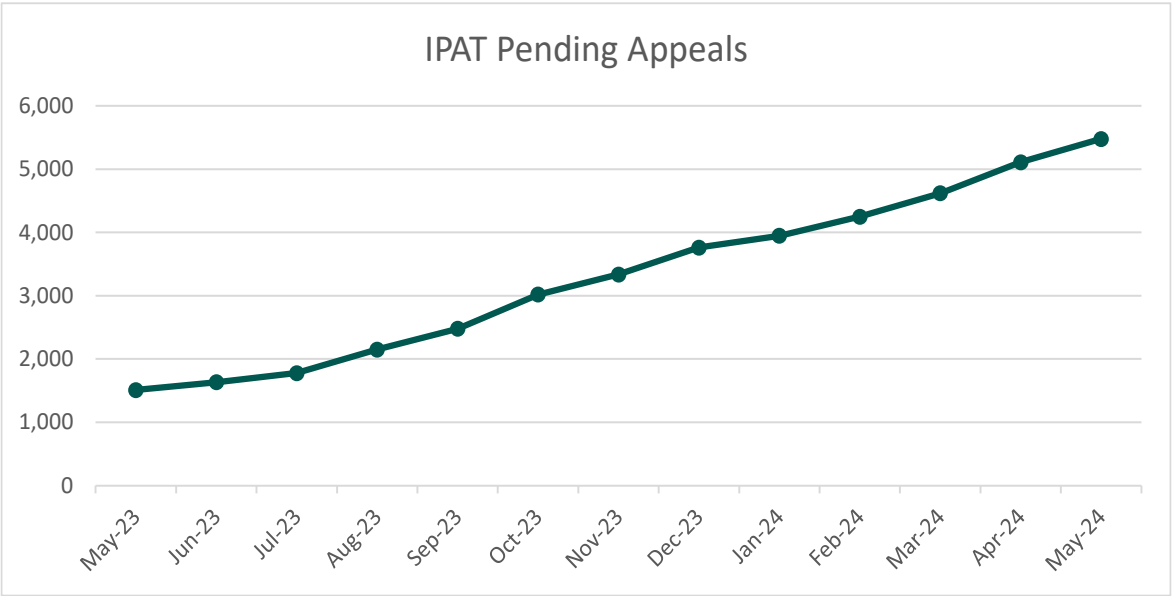
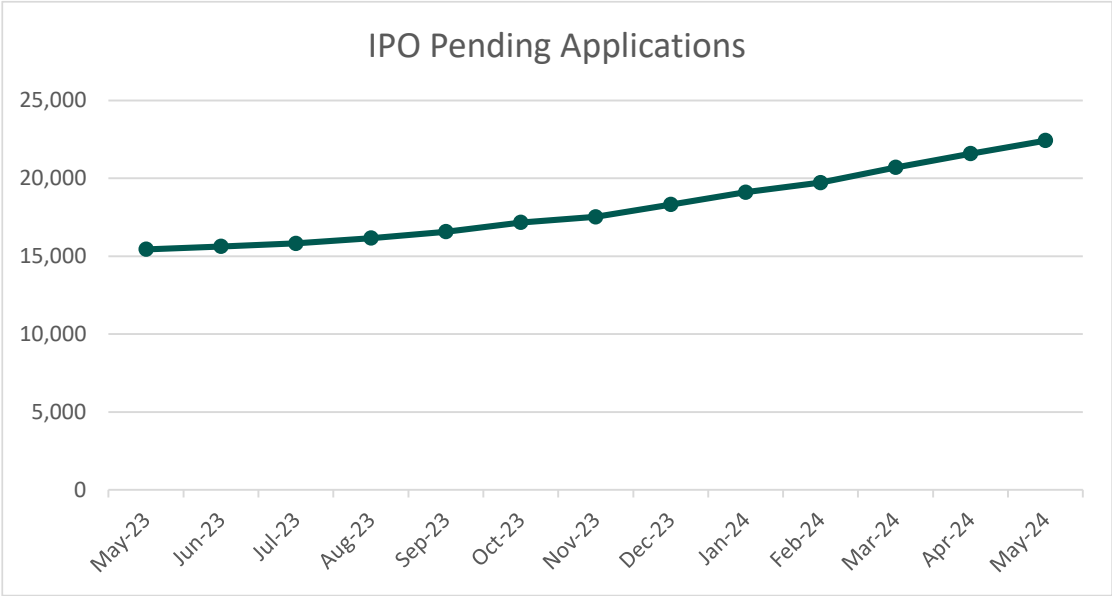
- The number of asylum applications continues to trend upwards. In May there were 2,010 applications received for asylum. This is up from 941 last May
- The main countries of origin for 2024 to date are: Nigeria (2,843 applications), Jordan (718), Pakistan (677), Bangladesh (600) and Somalia (586)
- The number of applications pending in the IPO is slowly trending upwards. As of May this year there were 22,419 applications pending
- The number of applications in the IPO where a recommendation has been made or otherwise closed off has continued to rise in May 2024 where 1,193 cases were closed off
- While there has been an increase in the number of cases processed, the median time to make a decision for standard cases has been trending slowly upwards (albeit from significant reductions). In May 2024 the median processing time to determination was 83 weeks (compared to 79 week in February 2024 and 72 in November 2023)
- The number of staff in the IPO has gradually been increasing, up to 410 at the end of May 2024
- Of those applications where a decision was made in May by MDU, 41% of decisions were refusals, 6% permission to remain, and 53% were international protection grants

Applications and main nationalities



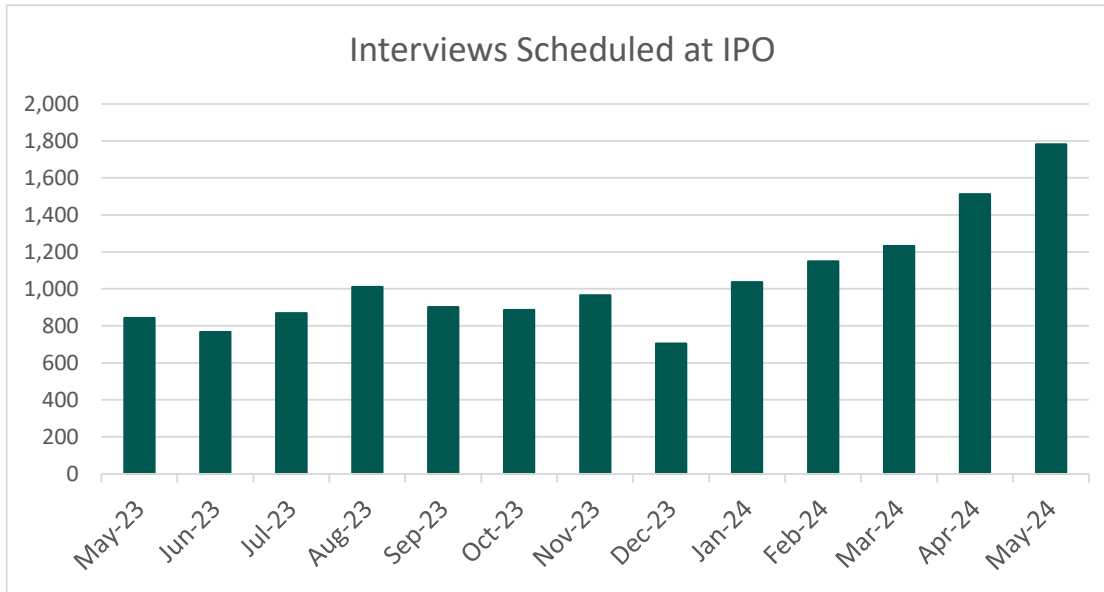
- In May there were 2,010 applications received for asylum. This is up from 941 last May. The average number of applications per month between June 2023 and May 2024 was 1,492
- For May 2024, the total number of applications included 520 from accelerated procedure (26% of all applicants)
- The main countries of origin for 2024 to date are: Nigeria (2,843 applications), Jordan (718), Pakistan (677), Bangladesh (600) and Somalia (586)

Pending International Protection Applications

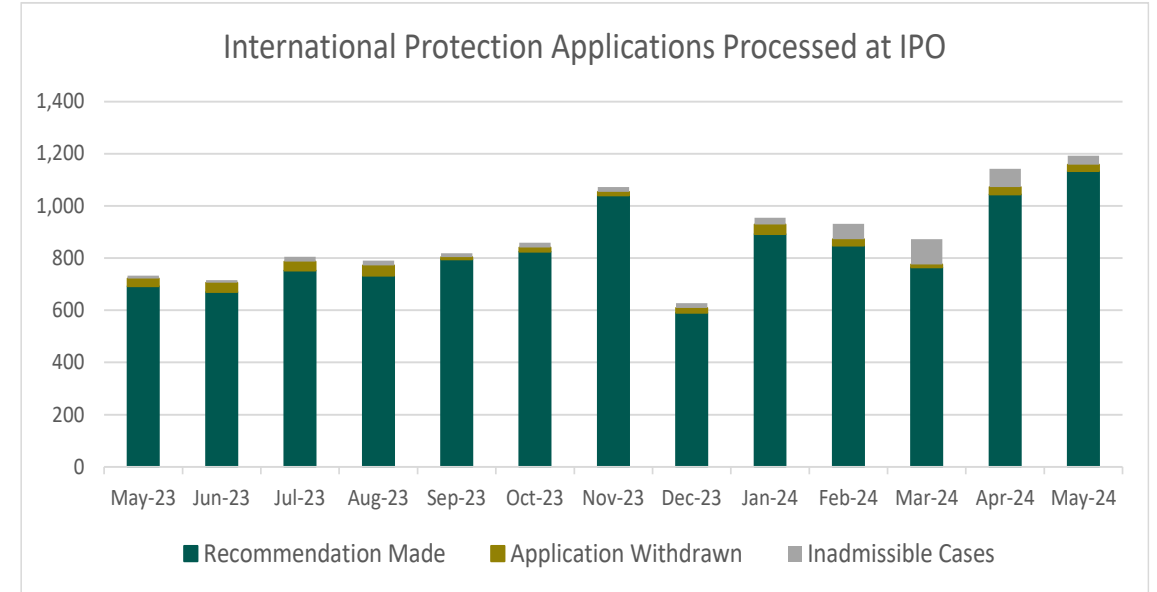


- The number of applications pending in the IPO is 22,419. The numbers have been slightly on the rise from September 2023 (16,566 cases pending)
- The number of pending applications for IPAT has been trending upwards since January 2023. In May 2024, there were 5,478 applications pending
- The pending figure for MDU at the end of May 2024 is 119

International Protection: Interviews and Applications Processed

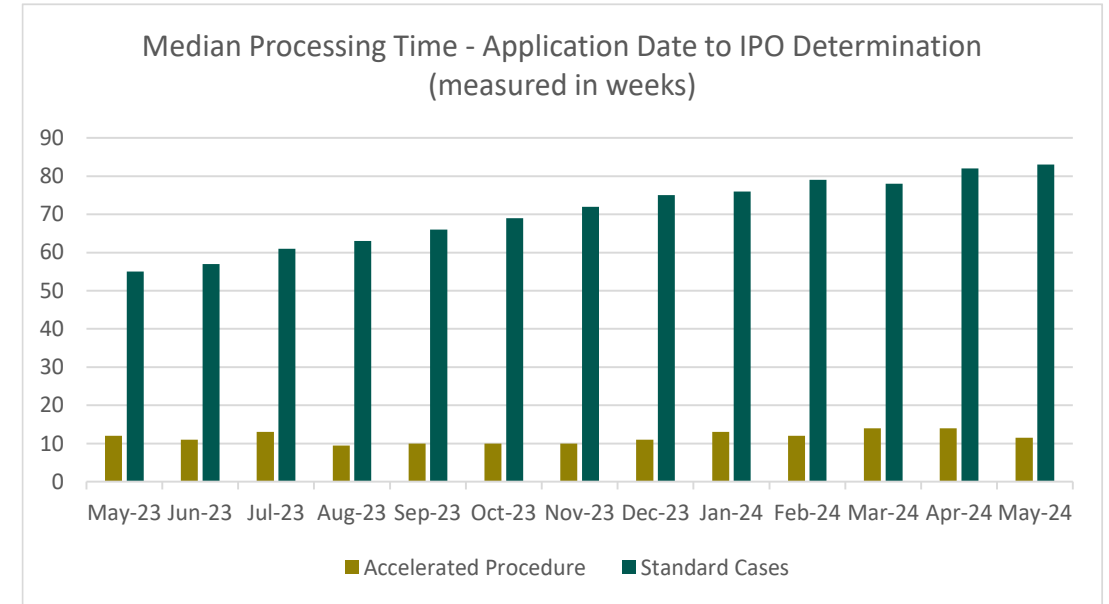
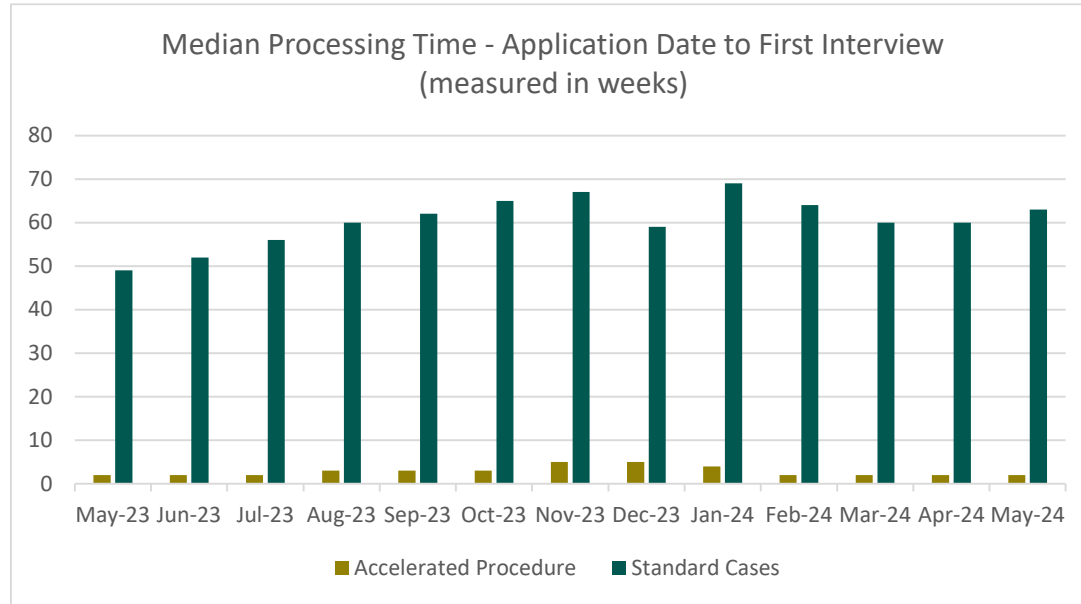


- The number of interviews scheduled at the IPO has been trending up since January 2024
- In May 2024, there were 1,782 interviews scheduled, up from 1,512 in April and 1,233 in March
- 2024 YTD interviews scheduled were 6,713 (a 84.6% increase on 3,636 interviews scheduled for 2023 YTD)



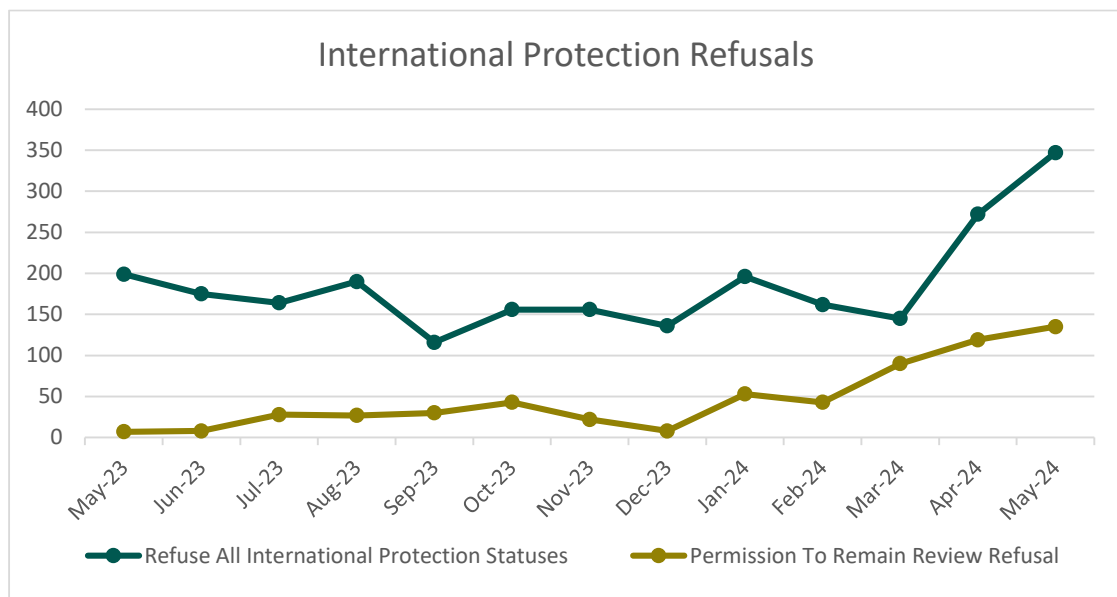
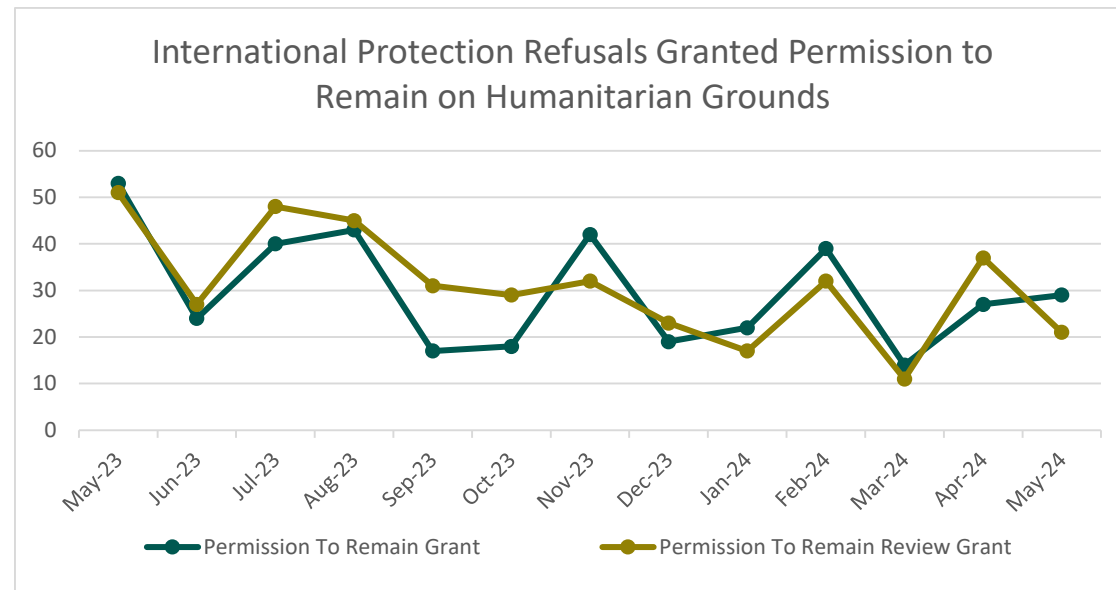
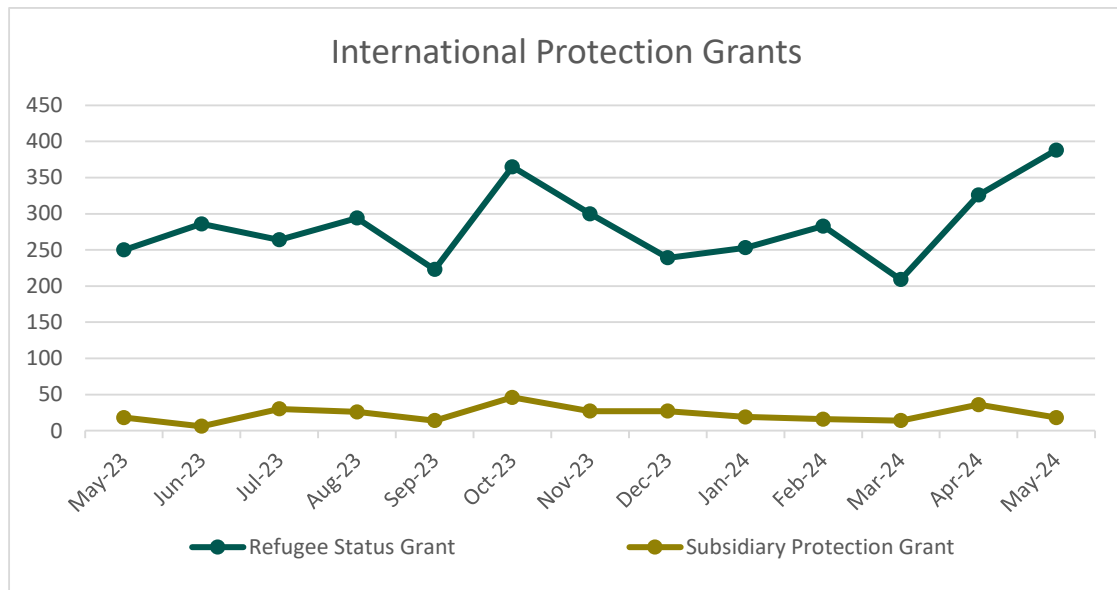
- This table is counting Recommendations Made, Applications Deemed Inadmissible and Applications Withdrawn
- In May 2024, 1,193 cases were closed off. This is up from 1,142 in April and up from 873 in March
- 2024 YTD applications processed were 5,094 (a 57.3% increase on 3,239 applications processed for 2023 YTD)

International Protection Applications Processing Times



- Processing times are measured as a median. This represents the middle number in the range of times at hand for processing. The reason why the average is not used is that there are a handful of cases where processing times are long – this would disproportionately impact the average figure and not give a proper representation of processing time
- The median time to the first interview for all applications had been slowly decreasing in 2024. In May 2024, it was 63 weeks for standard cases, slightly up from 60 weeks in April and 60 weeks in March
- For accelerated procedure only cases, the waiting time to the first interview for May was 2 weeks, same time as April and March
- The median processing time to determining an outcome to an asylum application has been slowly increasing
- In May 2024, the median processing time to determination for standard cases was 83 weeks (compared to 82 in April and 78 weeks in March)
- For accelerated procedure only, the median processing time was 11.5 weeks in May, down from 14 in April and March

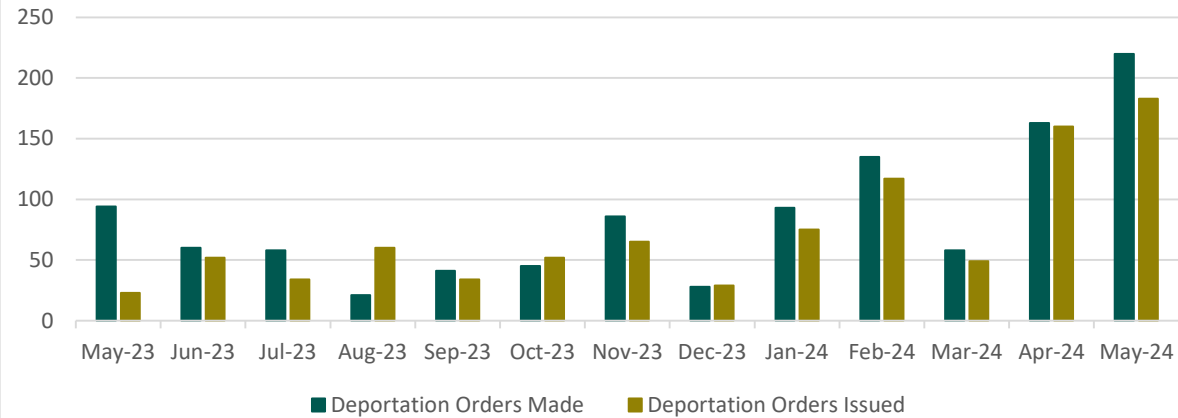
International Protection Decisions – Granted and Refused



- In May, of those applications where a decision was made, 388 were given refugee status grant and 18 subsidiary protection grant (406 in total). There is significant variation in these decisions over the last few months with no clear trend
- Of those who were refused refugee status and subsidiary protection, 29 were given Permission to Remain on humanitarian grounds with 21 on a Permission to Remain Review Grant. The number of Permissions to Remain has been trending downwards since May 2023 (when there were 104 Permissions to Remain)
- There were 315 refusals for International Protection Statuses and 135 for Permission to Remain Review
- Overall for May, 41% of decisions were refusals, 6% permission to remain, and 53% were international protection grants

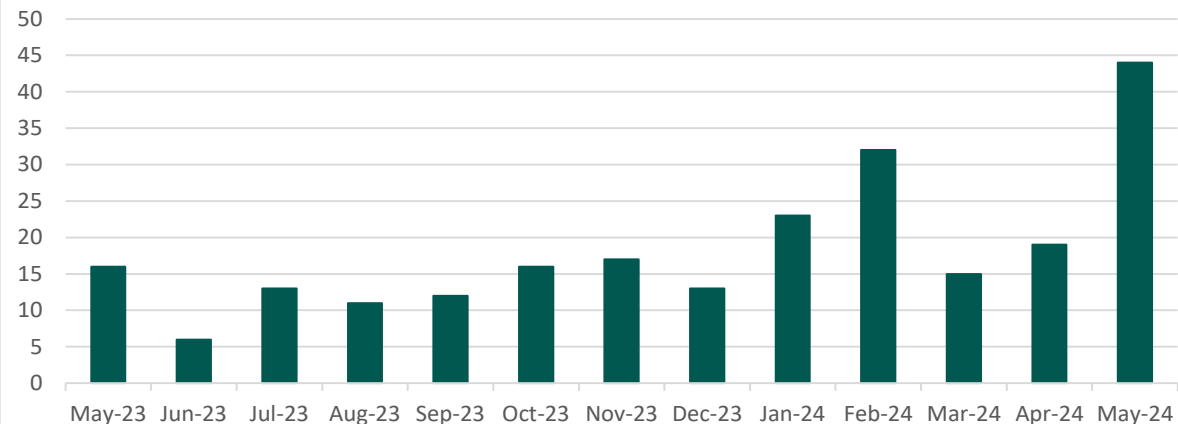
Deportation Orders and Enforcement/Removals

Deportation Orders where person had a previous International Protection application

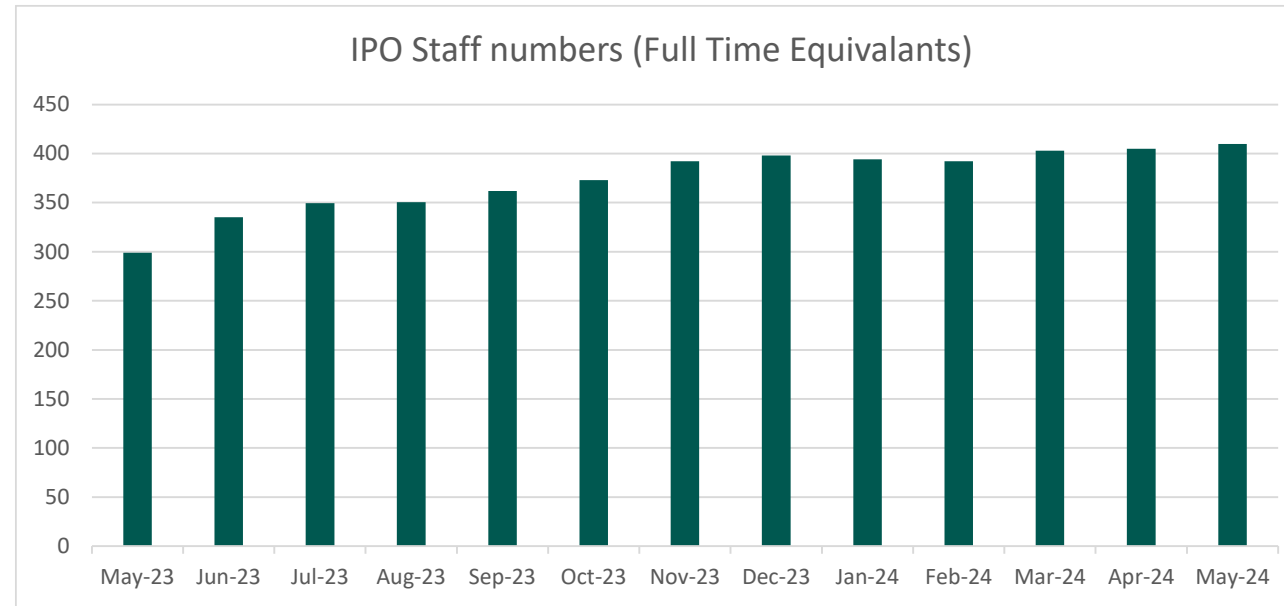


- For May 2024 the number of deportation orders signed (where a person had a previous asylum application) was 220 and the number of deportation orders issued was 183. For April, the figures were 163 and 160 respectively and for March it was 58 and 49 respectively
- For May 2024 the number of removals was 44

Enforcements and Returns where person had a previous International Protection application



IPO Staff number (Full-Time Equivalents)



- The number of staff in the IPO has gradually been increasing
- In May 2023 there were 299 FTEs in IPO. This number has been slowly trending upwards. In February 2024 392 and in November 2023 392
- At the end of May 2024, the IPO had 410 FTE staff



Appendix

Methodology

Pending International Protection Applications

- IPO – Data sourced from Lotus Notes
- IPAT – Data sourced from Lotus Notes
- MDU – Data sourced from AISIP. Pending figure does not include legacy cases – the legacy data has been captured in such a way that it cannot be accurately reported on

International Protection: Interviews and Applications Processed

- Data sourced from Lotus Notes

International Protection Applications Processing Times

- Data sourced from Lotus Notes
- Applicants to whom section 38(5) of the International Protection Act 2015 applies (failure to co-operate) are included in the calculations
- Where an interview took place after a case was reactivated the reactivation date is used as the application date, otherwise the original application date was used for the processing time calculation
- The median calculation is used for processing time at IPO as there are significant outliers in the length of time asylum applications can spend in processing. This is typically due to lengthy procedures such as judicial reviews which are complex and time consuming by their nature, and which are also outside of the remit and control of the IPO during that part of the process. The median is a more accurate measure of the time spent by the IPO in processing applications.

Methodology

International Protection Decisions – Granted and Refused

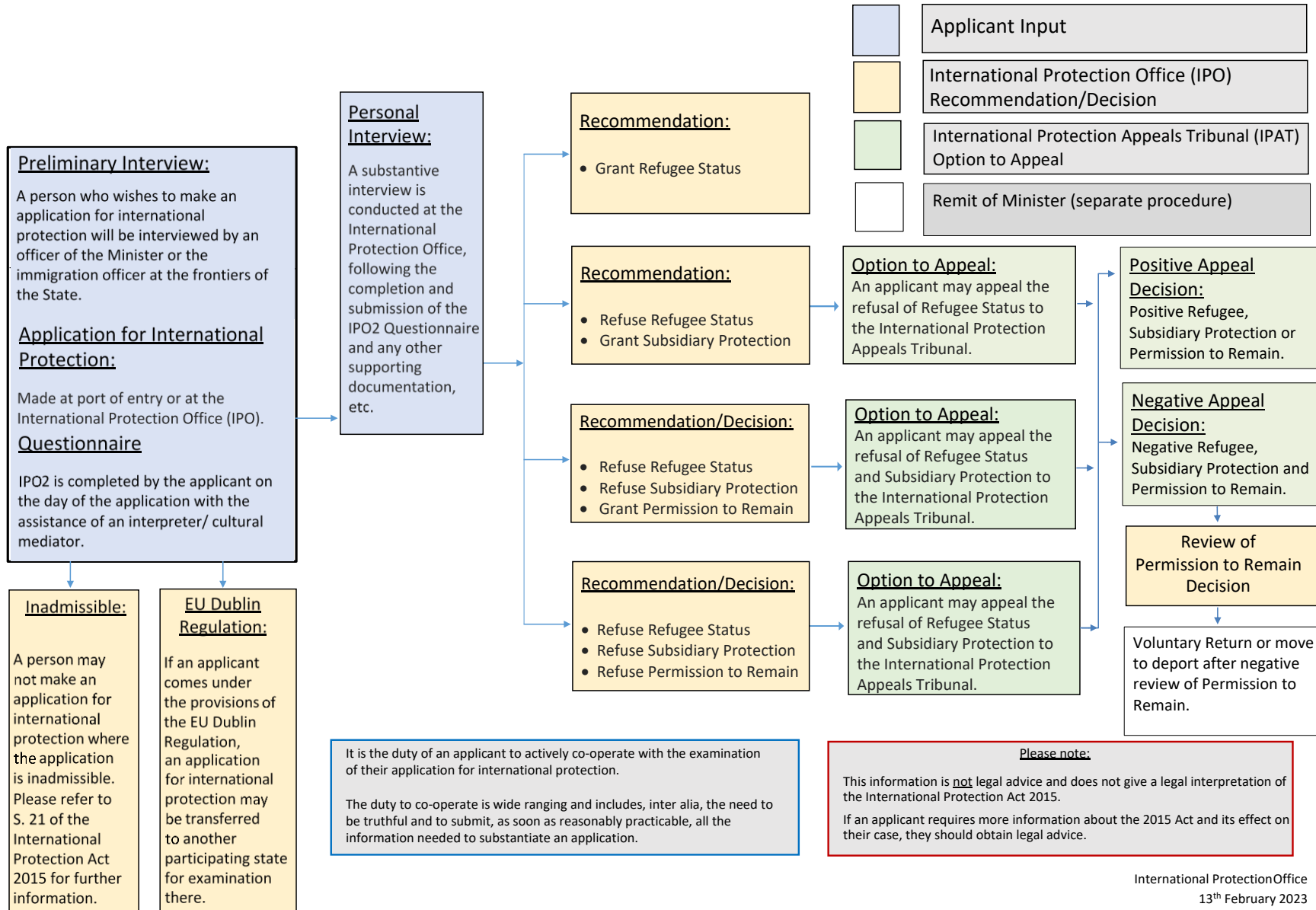
- Quashed decisions and Revocation of Status are not included
- Decision figures include international protection decisions (IPDN) and legacy application types
- Each applicant is represented once in the granted and refused tables
 - For example, if a person is refused refugee status but is granted subsidiary protection they are recorded once in the tables as a subsidiary protection grant. This is to more clearly represent the overall numbers of granted and refused applicants, and to avoid double counting of individuals where they are refused one type of status but are granted another.
- Some of the applicants who have been granted permission to remain are also included in the 'Refuse All International Protection Statuses' category of the refusals table. Permission to remain is a humanitarian permission. In order to be considered for permission to remain you must first have been refused international protection. On slide 7, the 'International Protection Refusals Granted Permission to Remain on Humanitarian Grounds' chart is a combination of applicants still in the asylum process and applicants who have finished the process. The 'International Protection Refusals' chart includes only those applicants who have finished the asylum process.
- Where a revocation occurs the original grant is removed from the figures for the month the permission was originally granted. For example, if an application was granted in January but subsequently revoked later in the year the January figure is updated to remove the grant

Deportation Orders and Enforcement/Removals

- Data for the International Protection Deportation Order (IPDP) application type is sourced from AISIP. All other data is sourced from Lotus Notes

General Overview of Process under International Protection Act 2015

General Overview of Process under International Protection Act 2015



Data Tables (1)

International Protection Office - Applications Received

	May-23	Jun-23	Jul-23	Aug-23	Sep-23	Oct-23	Nov-23	Dec-23	Jan-24	Feb-24	Mar-24	Apr-24	May-24
Accelerated Procedure	88	135	124	145	182	193	175	182	185	183	163	372	520
Standard Cases	853	766	904	1013	1066	1288	1289	1243	1588	1386	1659	1653	1490

International Protection Office – Top 5 Nationality Applications

Top 5 nationalities 2024 to date	Applications	Total
Nigeria	2843	30.9%
Jordan	718	7.8%
Pakistan	677	7.4%
Bangladesh	600	6.5%
Somalia	586	6.4%
Other	3775	41.0%
Total	9199	

Data Tables (2)

International Protection Office - Pending Applications

	May-23	Jun-23	Jul-23	Aug-23	Sep-23	Oct-23	Nov-23	Dec-23	Jan-24	Feb-24	Mar-24	Apr-24	May-24
IP Pending	15,446	15,629	15,823	16,165	16,566	17,171	17,524	18,314	19,109	19,719	20,695	21,577	22,419

International Protection Appeals Tribunal - Pending Applications

	May-23	Jun-23	Jul-23	Aug-23	Sep-23	Oct-23	Nov-23	Dec-23	Jan-24	Feb-24	Mar-24	Apr-24	May-24
IPAT Pending	1511	1635	1777	2150	2478	3020	3337	3762	3949	4251	4620	5110	5478

Ministerial Decisions Unit - Pending Applications

	May-23	Jun-23	Jul-23	Aug-23	Sep-23	Oct-23	Nov-23	Dec-23	Jan-24	Feb-24	Mar-24	Apr-24	May-24
Total	70	70	95	62	121	72	89	92	61	59	85	70	119

Data Tables (3)

International Protection Office – Interview Scheduled

	May-23	Jun-23	Jul-23	Aug-23	Sep-23	Oct-23	Nov-23	Dec-23	Jan-24	Feb-24	Mar-24	Apr-24	May-24
Interviews Scheduled	843	768	870	1011	902	887	966	705	1037	1149	1233	1512	1782

International Protection Office – Processed Cases

	May-23	Jun-23	Jul-23	Aug-23	Sep-23	Oct-23	Nov-23	Dec-23	Jan-24	Feb-24	Mar-24	Apr-24	May-24
Recommendation Made	692	670	752	733	795	825	1040	590	892	848	765	1044	1133
Application Withdrawn	30	36	35	39	9	16	14	19	37	25	10	28	25
Inadmissible Cases	11	9	18	18	15	18	18	18	26	58	98	70	35

Data Tables (4)

International Protection Office Median Process Time – Application Date to First Interview (measured in weeks)

	May-23	Jun-23	Jul-23	Aug-23	Sep-23	Oct-23	Nov-23	Dec-23	Jan-24	Feb-24	Mar-24	Apr-24	May-24
Accelerated Procedure	2	2	2	3	3	3	5	5	4	2	2	2	2
Standard Cases	49	52	56	60	62	65	67	59	69	64	60	60	63

International Protection Office Median Process Time – Application Date to IPO Determination (measured in weeks)

	May-23	Jun-23	Jul-23	Aug-23	Sep-23	Oct-23	Nov-23	Dec-23	Jan-24	Feb-24	Mar-24	Apr-24	May-24
Accelerated Procedure	12	11	13	9.5	10	10	10	11	13	12	14	14	11.5
Standard Cases	55	57	61	63	66	69	72	75	76	79	78	82	83

Data Tables (5)

International Protection Decisions – Grants

	May-23	Jun-23	Jul-23	Aug-23	Sep-23	Oct-23	Nov-23	Dec-23	Jan-24	Feb-24	Mar-24	Apr-24	May-24
Refugee Status Grant	250	286	264	294	223	365	300	239	253	283	209	326	388
Subsidiary Protection Grant	18	6	30	26	14	46	27	27	19	16	14	36	18
Permission To Remain Grant	53	24	40	43	17	18	42	19	22	39	14	27	29
Permission To Remain Review Grant	51	27	48	45	31	29	32	23	17	32	11	37	21

International Protection Decisions – Refusals

	May-23	Jun-23	Jul-23	Aug-23	Sep-23	Oct-23	Nov-23	Dec-23	Jan-24	Feb-24	Mar-24	Apr-24	May-24
Refuse All International Protection Statuses	199	175	164	190	116	156	156	136	196	162	145	272	347
Permission To Remain Refusal	7	8	28	27	30	43	22	8	53	43	90	119	135

Data Tables (6)

Deportation Orders where person had a previous International Protection application

	May-23	Jun-23	Jul-23	Aug-23	Sep-23	Oct-23	Nov-23	Dec-23	Jan-24	Feb-24	Mar-24	Apr-24	May-24
Deportation Orders Made	94	60	58	21	41	45	86	28	93	135	58	163	220
Deportation Orders Issued	23	52	34	60	34	52	65	29	75	117	49	160	183

Deportation Enforcements and Returns where person had a previous International Protection application

Enforcements/Returns	May-23	Jun-23	Jul-23	Aug-23	Sep-23	Oct-23	Nov-23	Dec-23	Jan-24	Feb-24	Mar-24	Apr-24	May-24
Total	16	6	13	11	12	16	17	13	23	32	15	19	44

Data Tables (7)

International Protection Office Staff Numbers (Full-Time Equivalents)

	May-23	Jun-23	Jul-23	Aug-23	Sep-23	Oct-23	Nov-23	Dec-23	Jan-24	Feb-24	Mar-24	Apr-24	May-24
IPO Staffing	299.1	335.1	349.5	350.5	361.9	373.1	392.1	398.1	394.1	392.1	402.85	404.85	409.7